Sets in Python

BEGINNER LESSON | Qspiders | Python 3

Learning goals: Create a set and understand unique items and item order.

1. What is a set?

A set stores unique items. Write a non-empty set inside braces `{}`, with items separated by commas. Python calls this type `set`.

2. Create and use

Duplicate items are kept only once. The `len()` function counts the items.

```
numbers = {1, 1, 2}
print(len(numbers))  # Output: 2
```

3. Check the type

Use `type()` to find a value's data type.

```
print(type(numbers))  # Output: <class 'set'>
```

4. Key points

- Sets have no guaranteed item order. Printed order may differ.
- You cannot read set items by index, such as `numbers[0]`.
- You can add or remove items after creating a set.
- Use `set()` for an empty set. `{}` creates an empty dictionary.

5. Try it yourself

Create a set containing `3, 3, 5`. Print its type and the number of items. The count should be `2`.